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AI Overview



To set the **setuid (SUID)** bit on an executable in macOS, use the `chmod u+s` command. This allows the program to run with the privileges of its owner (e.g., `root`) regardless of who executes it. For example, run `sudo chmod u+s /path/to/binary`. [dustinspecker.com +2](#)

Key Requirements & Constraints

Unlike some Unix systems, macOS imposes strict security policies on the setuid bit to prevent privilege escalation vulnerabilities: [Stack Overflow +2](#)

- **Ownership:** The executable must be owned by `root`. [Stack Overflow +1](#)
- **Directory Restrictions:** The executable must reside in a directory where all parent directories (all the way to the `/` root) are also owned by `root` and are not writable by other users. [Stack Overflow](#)
- **SIP:** If System Integrity Protection (SIP) is enabled, you cannot set the setuid bit on restricted system binaries even with `root` privileges. [Link](#)

Commands for SUID Management

1. Set the SUID bit:

bash

```
sudo chmod u+s /path/to/binary
```

Use code with caution.



2. Remove the SUID bit:

bash

```
sudo chmod u-s /path/to/binary
```

Use code with caution.



3. Verify the SUID bit:

Run `ls -l /path/to/binary`. You will see an `s` in the owner permissions field

instead of an `x` (e.g., `-rwsr-xr-x`). 🍌 CBT Nuggets +2

Could you tell me **what specific executable or script you are trying to modify**? This will help me determine if the SUID bit will work or if a different approach (like modifying the `sudoers` file or using Launch Daemons) is safer and more effective for your needs.

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How can I elevate the privileges of an executable using setuid on Mac?

Apr 2, 2023 — The setuid bit on an executable only has an effect if the executable is in a directory that is owned by root and not open for writ...



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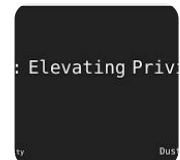
AOSX-13-001145 - All setuid executables on the macOS ...

Information. Very few of the executables that come preinstalled on the macOS host have the 'setuid' bit set, and administrators sh...

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setuid: Elevating Privileges | Dustin Specker

Aug 1, 2020 — Setuid is a Linux and macOS feature that instructs the operating system to run an executable as the owner of the executable instea...



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How can I elevate the privileges of an executable using ...

On **macOS**, the **setuid bit** on an executable has an effect only if the executable is in a directory that is owned by root (and not open for writing by others).

[How to distribute an OSX program with the suid bit set through ...](#) Apr 14, 2014

[Is there a way to add the setuid bit to a mac application bundle?](#) Jun 9, 2016

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Super User

<https://superuser.com> › questions › making-a-program-...

macos - Making a program always run as root in OS X

Aug 5, 2012 — I'm trying to make a C program run always as root, no matter who is calling it. Basically, I want it to invoke "mkdir /test" as an example. So I created ...

[2 answers](#) · Top answer: There are two things to know here: The sticky bit, which could be used on file...

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Stack Exchange

<https://apple.stackexchange.com> › questions › how-to-c...

How to create installable app with setuid bit set owned by ...

Jun 20, 2019 — You need to make the app call a command line script ... all the steps in this guide will show you how to craft the post install script.

[usr/local/bin/sudo must be owned by uid 0 and have ...](#) 2 answers Jan 22, 2022

[How to see 6-digit file permissions? - Apple ...](#) 1 answer May 10, 2018

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Apple Developer

<https://developer.apple.com> › man2 › setuid.2.html

Mac OS X Manual Page For setuid(2)

The setuid() function **sets the real and effective user IDs** and the saved set-user-ID of the current process to the specified value.

Missing: bit | Show results with: bit



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setuid: Elevating Privileges - Dustin Specker

Aug 1, 2020 — Linux and macOS support **setuid** . setuid instructs the OS to run an executable as the owner of the executable instead of the current user.



Red Canary

<https://redcanary.com> › techniques › setuid.setuid

<https://redcanary.com/techniques/setuid-setgid>

Setuid and Setgid - Red Canary Threat Detection Report

Adversaries modify **setuid (set user ID)** and setgid (set group ID) bits to elevate their permissions in macOS and Linux environments.



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Why mac os x does not set uid bit for /usr/bin/passwd

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Abuse Elevation Control Mechanism: Setuid and Setgid

The chmod command can set these bits with bitmasking, **chmod 4777 [file]** or via shorthand naming, **chmod u+s [file]** . This will enable the setuid bit. To enable ...

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